

took him 87 wrong answers to get to the right one...

Another way algorithms have evolved is their efficient use of the exabytes of data that all of us create. In 2007, Gavin Potter gained unconventional success while competing in the \$1 million Netflix Prize. The aim was to enhance the quality of suggestions that Netflix recommends to its users, and Potter's method worked more consistently than anyone else's. What's interesting is that while most competitors used data like the content of the user's current likes, Gavin's method used the user's past preferences to predict their future behaviour based on similarities with other users who exhibited similar preferences. This technique was further developed into collaborative filtering. Gavin Potter, along with Nick Tsionis, then founded RecSys, which now provides over 100 million personalised recommendations daily to various clients who outsource their data to the RecSys engine. Among their clients are publication giants Nature, who use it for search suggestions, and of course, many match-making websites. There's even white-labeldating.com, a website that helps you start your own dating service, in case you have the branding but lack the execution. As far as the efficiency of the algorithm for match-making goes, the algorithm still depends on the flawed dataset built using questions. That said, algorithms are constantly evolving, and soon, based on data from your social behaviour



A profile picture like this is a 100x match boost, and one with your dog will give you 50x

S.T.EYE

Strictly, this isn't a gadget, nor is it currently available. In fact, it was a concept developed by three teenagers from the Isaac Newton Academy in Ilford, Essex for a science competition. Daanyaal Ali, 14, Muaz Nawaz, 13, and Chirag Shah, 14 thought of using the humble condom to easily detect STDs. The condom, as they imagined it, would change colour depending on which infection it encounters. Back in 2014 when the concept was first revealed to the public, it generated a lot of press, most of which hailed it as an "invention". Of course it was only a concept and thus several reputed journals dismissed it as unfeasible. However, if you take a look at our Digital Diagnostics story in the Sci-Tech section, something like this doesn't seem too far fetched any longer. For paranoid folk like us, this invention is pretty much a must have!



Playing it safe was never this easy

over time, they will know you better than you know yourself.

MENTAL MATCH

Tinder recently revealed some statistics about its user base in India, and it turns out it's increasing rapidly. What's more, they revealed that women send out more super-likes than men. While we cannot say if the trend is replicated on all platforms, it is possible that meeting people online could be empowering for women. A place to let their hair down perhaps. Online dating is safer too, since most reputable services have additional algorithms to detect and remove fake profiles. If you are ultra-concerned about your safety then you can always take a premium subscription

from a reputed provider. Although, even that won't protect you from the occasional, self-destructive psychopath, it's really no more of a risk than you would face offline as well.

The best thing about dating apps is that both people get to control the flow – which is to say that you only meet when both agree, phone numbers are shared

at your discretion, and there's an overall feel of being in control, for both people.

Another huge advantage is that you aren't tied down to your existing friend circle, or friends of friends. It's exciting to meet someone totally new, who may come with totally fresh perspectives than what you're used to. Add to that the very important convenience of it not being awkward if it doesn't work out. Too many times people have ruined friendships because friends who introduced the two of you find themselves torn and having to take sides if it doesn't work out.

Then there's the ability to lower your inhibitions when meeting people who don't know your family or close friends. Many feel that they are only able to be honest with total strangers, because there is no fear of judgement if it doesn't work out.

People also seem to love texting, as it helps them be themselves, and avoid paralysing or awkward situations when they're tongue-tied. Of course, sometimes it turns out that a person can only communicate in texts and not in person, and that's hardly desirable.

Dating sites are especially beneficial to those looking for long term partners. While that may sound counter-intuitive, hear us out. With a dating site you get to meet a few